

Romania's record recycled table raises funds for children's hospital

From: DOGOnews Mined: 2026-10-03 5 min read

A community meal in Romania needed a remarkably long table: 3.1 miles, or 4.99 kilometers. About 20,000 people gathered at the Uniting Table in Bucharest on September 12, 2026.

The table set a Guinness World Record for the longest table made from recycled materials. **Recycling** means processing used materials so they can serve another purpose. In this case, those materials became a place for thousands of people to share a meal.

The organizer, **nonprofit** Bloom The World, had another goal alongside the record. The event raised more than \$110,000 for Romania's first **psychiatric** hospital for children. A **psychiatric** hospital provides specialist care for mental health and related needs. The planned hospital will care for children with conditions including depression, autism and ADHD.

Children in Bucharest who need mental health care are currently treated in an outdated **facility**. Its large, crowded **wards** lack basic **privacy**. The new hospital is scheduled to open in 2027.

This was Bloom's second record of this kind. In 2025, the organization brought together 10,000 people around a table made from recycled materials in Alba Iulia, Romania. That table measured 1.7 miles, or 2.7 kilometers. The earlier event focused on bringing people together and raising awareness of environmental issues.

Bloom intends to recycle the latest table's materials again to make children's furniture. After providing a shared dining space, the materials have another planned purpose.

Word Treasure

Recycling -- Processing used materials so they can serve another purpose.

nonprofit -- An organization that works for a cause instead of sharing profits with owners.

psychiatric -- Related to medical care for mental health.

facility -- A building or place used for a particular service.

wards -- Hospital areas where patients receive care.

privacy -- Having personal space and keeping personal matters to yourself.

Background you need

Recycling means processing used materials so they can serve another purpose.
A psychiatric hospital provides specialist care for mental health and related needs.

Break it down

Introduces the meal's location, date, attendance and table length.
Explains the record and the use of recycled materials.
Describes the fundraising goal and planned children's hospital.
Explains the current facility's conditions and the planned opening year.
Provides context from Bloom's 2025 event.
Closes with the planned recycling of the table into children's furniture.

Why it matters

The event combined a community gathering with fundraising for a planned children's hospital. It also connected the use of recycled materials with a further planned use as children's furniture.

Test what you remember

1. What Guinness World Record did the Uniting Table set?

- ☐ (A) The heaviest table made from recycled materials
- ☐ (B) The longest table made from recycled materials
- ☐ (C) The tallest table made from recycled materials
- ☐ (D) The widest table made from recycled materials

2. How much money did the 2026 event raise?

- ☐ (A) More than \$20,000
- ☐ (B) More than \$100,000
- ☐ (C) More than \$10,000
- ☐ (D) More than \$110,000

3. What problem does the article describe at the current care facility?

- ☐ (A) Its waiting rooms have too few books.
- ☐ (B) Its dining rooms need larger tables.
- ☐ (C) Its outdoor paths need better lighting.
- ☐ (D) Its crowded wards lack basic privacy.

4. How many people gathered at Bloom's 2025 event?

- ☐ (A) About 20,000 people
- ☐ (B) About 5,000 people
- ☐ (C) About 10,000 people
- ☐ (D) About 15,000 people

5. What did Bloom's earlier event focus on?

- ☐ (A) Community gathering and environmental awareness
- ☐ (B) Reading activities and local history
- ☐ (C) Sports participation and healthy eating
- ☐ (D) Music performances and artistic skills

6. What is planned for the latest table's materials?

- ☐ (A) Recycling them into playground equipment
- ☐ (B) Recycling them into museum displays
- ☐ (C) Recycling them into garden fences
- ☐ (D) Recycling them into children's furniture

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: C 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):